

SOPA DE ELOTE

INGREDIENTS

1/4 cup olive or vegetable oil

6 cups fresh corn kernels , from 8-10 shucked cobs (save 6 of the stripped cobs for simmering the soup)

1 cup chopped yellow onion

1/4 teaspoon chipotle powder or paste (use more or less, depending on your heat preferences)*

1/2 tsp paprika

1/2 tsp cumin

kosher salt and freshly ground black pepper

2 large garlic cloves , chopped (about 1 tablespoon)

4 cups chicken or vegetable broth

1/2 cup sour cream

1/2 cup grated dry/aged Cotija cheese , plus additional for garnish (substitute Parmesan or Romano if Cotija is unavailable)

1 tablespoon fresh lime juice

1 teaspoon grated lime zest

2 tablespoons plus 2 teaspoons chopped cilantro , divided

INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Heat oil in a large, nonstick pot or cast iron Dutch oven until shimmering. Add corn kernels, chopped onion, chili powder, cumin and parika, 1/2 teaspoon salt, and 1/2 teaspoon black pepper. Cook over medium-high heat, stirring frequently, until onions are soft and corn is lightly charred in spots, about 8-10 minutes.

Step 2: Add garlic and cook until fragrant, 1 minute. Remove 1-1/2 cups of corn mixture from the pot and set aside. Stir broth and 6 stripped corn cobs into the pot, scraping up the brown bits on the bottom. Bring to a boil, reduce heat, and simmer for 20 minutes.

Step 3: Use tongs to remove corn cobs from pot and discard.

Step 4: Stir sour cream and Cotija into the soup. Transfer soup to a blender or food processor (in batches, depending on the size of your unit for safety) to puree until smooth.

Step 5: Return soup to pot and if needed, gently reheat to desired serving temperature. Stir in half (3/4 cup) of the reserved corn mixture, lime juice, and 2 tablespoons chopped cilantro. Season to taste with salt, pepper, and chili powder.

Step 6: Toss remaining 3/4 cup corn with lime zest and 2 teaspoons chopped cilantro. Serve soup, topped with a few spoonfuls of the corn mixture, and an extra sprinkling of Cotija.

THE COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef

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